

Spiritual Gems and Bible Reading - August 17-23, 2026

Spiritual Gems and Bible Reading — Week of August 17-23, 2026

Bible reading: Jeremiah 26-28 | Assigned reading: Jeremiah 28:5-17 “What spiritual gems from this week’s Bible reading would you like to share?”

Includes a prepared answer for the official Spiritual Gems question, 15 comment options, 2 research/insight angles, and Bible reading delivery notes. The comment options avoid the Treasures verses (Jer 26:2-6; 27:14, 15) and the official Spiritual Gems question (Jer 26:20-23).

Official Spiritual Gems Question

Jeremiah 26:20-23

Question: What lesson may Jeremiah have learned from Urijah? (jr 122 ¶18)

Answer option (~30 sec): Jeremiah may have learned that courage does not mean pretending danger is not real. Urijah also prophesied Jehovah’s message, but when threatened, he fled to Egypt and was still brought back and killed. Jeremiah could see that safety did not come from running away from his assignment. The safest course was to stay loyal, keep speaking Jehovah’s word, and trust Jehovah with the outcome.

Comment Options

15 comment options + 2 research/insight angles (highlighted in blue in the HTML/PDF). Each comment is about 20-30 seconds spoken.

#	Verse	What I take away
1	Jer 26:2	Jehovah’s message should not be reduced to make it easier
2	Jer 26:3	Jehovah still looked for repentance
3	Jer 26:4, 5	Listening includes responding to repeated warnings
4	Jer 26:8	A faithful message can provoke an unfair reaction

#	Verse	What I take away
5	Jer 26:12	Jeremiah stayed calm and kept the issue centered on Jehovah
6	Jer 26:13	Courage includes offering people a way back
7	Jer 26:14, 15	Jeremiah placed his life in Jehovah's hands
8	Jer 26:16	Honest listeners can still recognize truth under pressure
9	Jer 26:19	Humility can change the outcome of a warning
10	Jer 27:5	Jehovah has the right to give authority as he chooses
11	Jer 27:6	Jehovah can use even an imperfect ruler as his servant
12	Jer 27:8	Refusing Jehovah's direction makes suffering worse
13	Jer 28:6	Jeremiah wanted peace, but not at the cost of truth
14	Jer 28:9	Fulfillment proves the prophet
15	Jer 28:15	False reassurance can make people trust a lie
R1	Jer 26:12-15	 <i>Jeremiah book</i> : Jeremiah defended Jehovah's message, not himself
R2	Jer 28:10-17	 <i>Insight book</i> : Hananiah's death exposed false prophecy quickly

1 • Jeremiah 26:2

“Do not take away a word.”

Jer 26:2 reminds me that Jehovah's message was not Jeremiah's to edit. He had to say all that Jehovah commanded, even the parts people would dislike. That is a good lesson for our ministry. We speak tactfully, but we do not shrink Bible truth down until it becomes harmless. Jehovah's full message is what can save lives.

2 • Jeremiah 26:3

“Perhaps they will listen.”

What I find touching in Jer 26:3 is Jehovah's hopefulness. Even when Judah deserved judgment, Jehovah still said, "Perhaps they will listen." He was looking for repentance, not looking for an excuse to punish. That helps me view people in the ministry with hope. As long as Jehovah is still inviting them to listen, I should not write them off.

3 • Jeremiah 26:4, 5

"Whom I have sent to you again and again."

Jer 26:4, 5 shows that Jehovah had been patient for a long time. He kept sending his servants "again and again," but the people did not listen. That helps me see that listening is more than hearing words. It means responding while there is still time. Repeated reminders from Jehovah are not irritating repetition; they are evidence of mercy.

4 • Jeremiah 26:8

"You will surely die."

Jer 26:8 shows how quickly people can attack the messenger when they dislike the message. Jeremiah had spoken what Jehovah commanded, yet they said he deserved to die. This prepares me for opposition. If a Bible truth produces a negative reaction, it does not mean the truth was wrong or that we failed. Jeremiah was faithful, even when the response was hostile.

5 • Jeremiah 26:12

"Jehovah sent me."

In Jer 26:12, Jeremiah did not make the trial mainly about himself. He said, "Jehovah sent me." That calm answer kept the issue clear. He was not attacking Judah; he was delivering Jehovah's warning. In the ministry, that helps me not take rejection too personally. The message belongs to Jehovah, and my role is to

deliver it faithfully and respectfully.

6 • Jeremiah 26:13

“Reform your ways.”

Jer 26:13 shows Jeremiah’s courage and love. Even while his life was being threatened, he still urged the people to reform so Jehovah would hold back calamity. He did not become bitter or just defend himself. He still wanted them to live. That is the spirit I want in the ministry: not just proving a point, but helping people come back to Jehovah.

7 • Jeremiah 26:14, 15

“I am in your hand.”

Jer 26:14, 15 is powerful because Jeremiah accepted that the people could kill him, but he did not compromise. He put his life in Jehovah’s hands and warned them that innocent blood would be on them. That is real courage. He was not reckless, but he feared Jehovah more than men. Loyalty gave him calmness under threat.

8 • Jeremiah 26:16

“This man does not deserve to die.”

Jer 26:16 encourages me because not everyone joined the mob. Some princes and people listened and recognized that Jeremiah had spoken in Jehovah’s name. That reminds me not to assume the whole audience is against the truth. Even in tense situations, honest-hearted people may be listening quietly and may later take a stand for what is right.

9 • Jeremiah 26:19

“Jehovah changed his mind.”

Jer 26:19 refers to Hezekiah’s response to Micah’s warning. Instead of killing the prophet, Hezekiah feared Jehovah and sought His favor, and Jehovah showed mercy. That teaches me the value of humility. A warning can become a blessing if I respond to it quickly. Jehovah is pleased when correction moves a person to change.

10 • Jeremiah 27:5

“I have made the earth.”

Jer 27:5 sets the issue in the biggest possible frame. Jehovah made the earth, humans, and animals, so he has the right to decide who receives authority and for how long. That helps me trust him even when world events seem confusing. Human governments rise and fall, but Jehovah remains the Owner and Ruler of everything.

11 • Jeremiah 27:6

“My servant.”

Jer 27:6 calls Nebuchadnezzar Jehovah’s servant, not because he worshipped Jehovah, but because Jehovah used him to accomplish His judgment. That helps me see Jehovah’s sovereignty. He can direct events even through people who do not know him. So I do not need to panic over powerful human rulers. Jehovah can still use events to fulfill his purpose.

12 • Jeremiah 27:8

“The nation that will not serve him.”

Jer 27:8 shows that resisting Jehovah’s direction would not bring freedom; it would bring more suffering. Sometimes Jehovah’s direction may feel humbling, like accepting Babylonian domination was for Judah. But obedience is always safer than proud resistance. This teaches me to ask, not “What feels easiest?” but “What is Jehovah clearly directing?”

13 • Jeremiah 28:6

“Amen! May Jehovah do so!”

Jer 28:6 shows Jeremiah’s balanced heart. When Hananiah predicted peace and a quick return, Jeremiah said, in effect, “May it happen.” He was not eager for disaster. But he still would not accept a pleasant message just because it sounded comforting. That teaches me to love peace, but also to love truth more than comforting words.

14 • Jeremiah 28:9

“When the word of the prophet comes true.”

Jer 28:9 gives a simple test: fulfillment matters. A prophet who promises peace is proved true only when the word comes true. That helps me today because many voices make confident claims. I need discernment. Jehovah does not ask us to be impressed by confidence, popularity, or tone. He teaches us to compare claims with his Word and with fulfilled truth.

15 • Jeremiah 28:15

“You have made this people trust in a lie.”

Jer 28:15 shows the danger of false reassurance. Hananiah was not merely mistaken; he made people trust a lie. That is serious because false comfort can keep people from taking lifesaving action. In the ministry, I want to offer real comfort from Jehovah, not soft words that ignore his standards or the urgency of the times.



R1 • Jeremiah 26:12-15 — *Jeremiah book connection*

Defending Jehovah’s message

The *Jeremiah* book highlights that Jeremiah courageously faced opposition, but Jer 26:12-15 shows the spirit behind that courage. He did not give a proud self-defense. He pointed to Jehovah as the Source of the message and urged the people to reform. That teaches me that courage and humility can work together. We defend Jehovah’s truth, not our own importance.



R2 • Jeremiah 28:10-17 — *Insight book connection*

Hananiah exposed

The account of Hananiah shows how quickly Jehovah can expose a false prophet. Hananiah dramatically broke the yoke bar and promised relief, but Jehovah’s word through Jeremiah came true: Hananiah died that same year. That reminds me that confident religious claims do not impress Jehovah. Truth is proved by Jehovah’s backing, not by drama or popularity.

Bible Reading Assignment — Jeremiah 28:5-17

Study 5: Accurate Reading

Main objective

Read exactly what is written, with clear pronunciation and careful attention to punctuation. The passage has dialogue, contrast, and a serious conclusion, so the goal is dignified accuracy rather than dramatic exaggeration.

Suggested reading flow

Verses	Thought	Reading approach
5-9	Jeremiah responds to Hananiah	Read calmly; let Jeremiah sound balanced, not sarcastic
10-11	Hananiah breaks the yoke bar	Slightly emphasize the action and Hananiah's confidence
12-14	Jehovah gives Jeremiah the answer	Use a firm, sober tone; make the contrast between wooden and iron yoke bars clear
15-17	Hananiah is exposed and dies	Slow down; let the seriousness of false prophecy come through

Practice reminders

- Pronounce the names clearly: Jeremiah, Hananiah, Nebuchadnezzar, Babylon.
- Pause after “Amen! May Jehovah do so!” so the balance of Jeremiah’s response is clear.
- In verse 15, stress the contrast between “Jehovah has not sent you” and “you have made this people trust in a lie.”
- Avoid rushing the final verse; it is the proof that Jehovah’s word came true.

Verified source pages

- English meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/jw-meeting-workbook/july-august-2026-mwb/Life-and-Ministry-Meeting-Schedule-for-August-17-23-2026/>
- English book study: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/books/walk-courageously-with-god/patriarchs-to-time-of-judges/abraham-first-man-to-wage-a-righteous-war/>